# RADIO FAMILIARITY

13th Legion — Training Reference

Comms Basics · Training Block 3 · 2026

## 1. WHAT THIS LESSON IS

This is the radio half of Comms Basics: who is on which net, and how you keep that net from telling on you. How you talk once you have the station is **Net Etiquette**. What you send once you have them is **Reports**.

The block is foundational only. It is meant to be applied and practiced on FTXs, not memorized once and shelved.

## 2. THE NET

Figure 1 in the block is a scalable structure. Command and the field are not the same radio.

| ECHELON | WHO | NET |
|---|---|---|
| **Command** | Command staff, medical, and logistics | Ops Command Radio — CRO and BCRO |
| **Field, flat** | Static security, dynamic security, QRF, fireteam 1, fireteam 2, and so on | Each on an FRO |
| **Field, by squad** | Squad 1: FT1 and FT2. Squad 2: FT3 and FT4. Scale from there. | FT1 and FT3 on FRO. FT2 and FT4 on BFRO. |

> **TIME-CRITICAL COMMS** is its own path, drawn between command staff and the ops command radio. The field teams hang off that ops command radio. The deck uses the labels CRO, BCRO, FRO, and BFRO and does not spell the letters out.

## 3. COMMUNICATION SECURITY — ALWAYS

ComSec applies in the field and out of it. It is more than the radio in your hand.

- **Do not share frequencies, channels, or intel.** Need-to-know.
- **Minimize the RF footprint.** That is radio settings, where you put the radio, and sound discipline.
- **The 3 C's:** Clear, Concise, Correct. A short correct transmission is a smaller footprint than a long one.
- **Callsigns on the radio only.** Not in the open, and not as a habit off the net.
- **Codewords, brevity codes, and shackle codes** are how you say the thing without saying the thing.

## 4. BREVITY CODES

These are the codes taught in this block. Treat them as the training set. Live codes stay need-to-know and can change without this page changing.

| CODE | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **Ruby** | Request for AO entry |
| **Eureka** | Move to checkpoint 2 |
| **Ficus** | Return to base |
| **Pine** | Ready for authentication |
| **Viper** | Reached NAI Smokey |
| **Gravy** | Switch to alternate freq |
| **Fanta** | QRF en route |

## 5. SHACKLE CODES

A shackle code is a 10-letter word. Each letter is one digit, 0 through 9. You send the letter, not the number. This block uses shackle for **RTB authentication** and for **relaying a grid**.

The training key in this block:

| LETTER | S | C | U | B | A | D | I | V | E | R |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Digit** | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |

> **HOW YOU USE IT:** A 4 is "A". A 0 is "S". A grid that starts 10 starts "C S". Read it as letters on the air. The word SCUBADIVER is the training key on the slide, not a standing live code.

## 6. WHEN YOU CANNOT RAISE THEM

The call itself, and how long you wait, is Net Etiquette. If the station still does not answer, the radio is the problem. Check these, in the order the block gives them:

| CHECK | WHAT IS WRONG |
|---|---|
| **Line of sight** | Terrain is between you and them. |
| **Sit up or stand** | The antenna is in the dirt, or you are. |

| | |
|---|---|
| **up** | |
| **Foliage** | Brush attenuates the signal. |
| **Low vs high** | Transmit power. Low is quieter and shorter. High reaches farther and is louder to everyone else. |